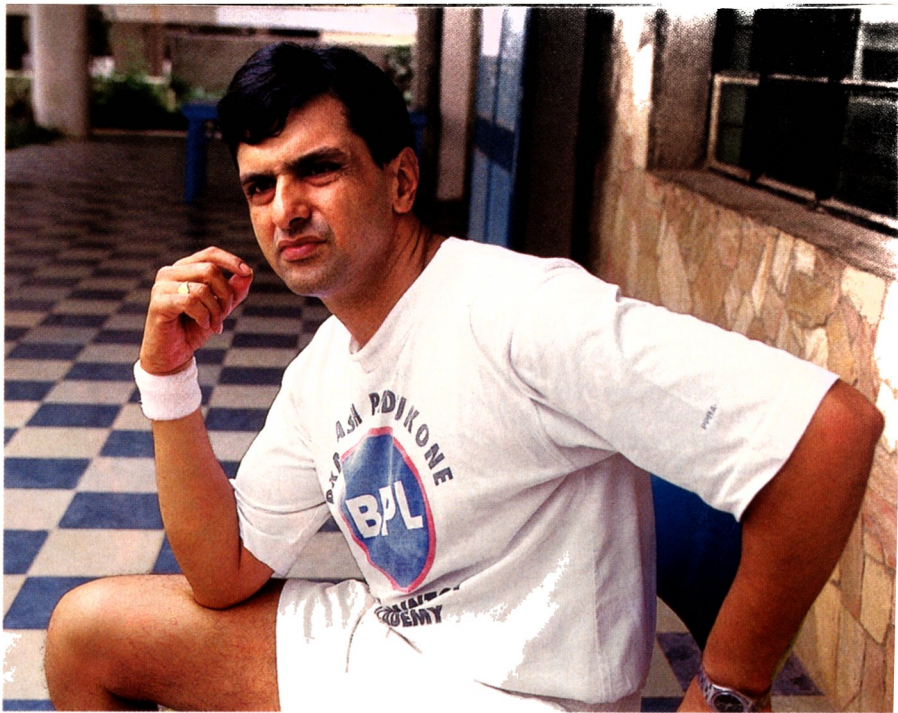
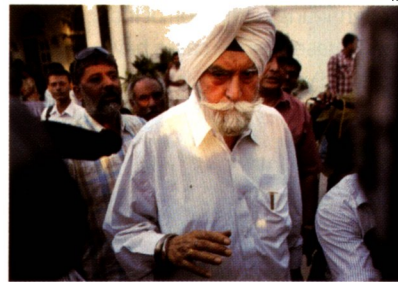


2 On a Different Court Padukone vs BAI

Prakash Padukone, India's greatest badminton player, became the unusual leader of a revolution when he set up the Indian Badminton Confederation as a rival to the Badminton Association of India (BAI), causing a schism in the sport. He wanted to reform the way badminton was played in India. "For a man like Padukone to have behaved so out of character is indicative of the magnitude of the problem," said INDIA TODAY in March 1996.



H K RAJASEKHAR



3 A Self Goal Gill Drops Six Senior Players

This was the decisive crushing of player power. In 1998, IHF President K.P.S. Gill celebrated the Asian Games hockey gold by sacking the six most senior players. In March 1996, INDIA TODAY had foretold the game's death: "Everywhere this pungent smell of decay oozes from Indian hockey. Gill, inheritor of a disintegrating game in 1994, padded over some of the cracks but when an entire edifice is crumbling, a tube of quickfix is inadequate."

4 Foul Play Cricket Match-Fixing

This is one controversy cricket-crazy Indians will never forget. It all started in 2000, with the Delhi Police tapping South African captain Hansie Cronje's phone and stumbling on names that spelt match-fixing. INDIA TODAY said in April 2000, "A mortar round has been fired into cricket's stomach and it's no good if administrators bring out a box of band-aids." A number of names tumbled out of the closet including Indian skipper Mohammad Azharuddin. The word bookie entered our everyday vocabulary. There was nothing gentlemanly left in the Gentleman's Game.

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